

Chapter 2: The "Rules" (Law, Ethics & Accessibility) - Guided Notes

Name: _____ Date: __ Class/Period: __

Essential Question:

How do ethical standards, web law, and accessibility guidelines ensure a safe and inclusive internet for everyone?

PART 1: Intellectual Property & Web Law

1. Protecting the Mind's Work: Everything created with the mind is considered _____ Property.

- _____: Automatic legal protection for original creative works (like code, photos, or text).
- **Trademark:** Protects brand identity (like logos or slogans).
- **Patent:** Protects new inventions or physical processes.

2. Ethical Sourcing: You cannot just right-click and save any image from Google for a client. To share work legally, we use ____ licenses, or we use work from the ____ (where copyright has expired and is free for anyone to use).

3. Corporate Secrets: An **NDA** stands for Non-_____ Agreement. It is a legal contract professionals sign to protect a company's ____ (proprietary info like code logic or client lists).

PART 2: Designing for All (Accessibility)

4. The Curb Cut Effect: This is the sociological principle that designing for _____ users (like building a wheelchair ramp on a sidewalk) inherently makes the product better for _____ (like people with strollers or luggage).

5. Accessibility Laws & Standards:

- **ADA:** The Americans with Disabilities Act. In the famous Domino's Pizza lawsuit, the Supreme Court ruled that websites are public accommodations and _____ be accessible.
- **WCAG:** Web Content _____ Guidelines. This is the international rulebook for making sure sites work for screen readers and keyboard-only users.

6. Technical Accessibility Markers:

- **Alt-Text:** The `alt` attribute is mandatory for images. It provides a text description of the image for ____ used by the visually impaired.
- **Semantic Tags:** Using tags like `<h1>` and `<nav>` instead of `<div>` tags so that machines can understand the structure of the page.
- **Color** _____: Ensuring there is a high enough mathematical difference in brightness between text and its background so it is readable.

PART 3: Digital Ethics & UI Manipulation

7. Probity: In professional development, **Probity** means strict adherence to the highest principles of _____ conduct, honesty, and integrity.

8. Dark Patterns: Dark Patterns are deceptive User Interface (UI) tricks meant to _____ users into taking actions they didn't intend to take.

9. Types of Dark Patterns:

- **Confirmshaming:** Making the user feel _____ for clicking the "No" or "Opt-Out" option.
- **Roach Motel:** A subscription or service that is incredibly easy to get into, but almost _____ to cancel or get out of.



CORNELL SUMMARY

Summary Prompt: In 3-4 complete sentences, explain the "Curb Cut Effect" and provide one specific example of how a web developer applies it to a website.